

Naresh Giri, 54
Haridwar, Uttarakhand

What makes him a water warrior: Naresh Giri turned a newspaper article into action, launching a **one-man cleanup drive** at Har Ki Pauri. Armed with a broom and determination, he refused to wait for authorities, transforming his Maruti into a mobile cleanup force. His relentless efforts inspired locals, turning sporadic cleanups into a sustained movement. Giri's philosophy is simple: don't complain, clean. His dedication became even more evident during COVID-19, when the Ganga's natural revival reinforced his mission. Through sheer perseverance, he has redefined environmental responsibility, proving that monumental change begins with one committed individual.



Sanjay Sajjan, 56
Aurangabad, Bihar

What makes him a water warrior: Sanjay Sajjan transformed Aurangabad's water crisis into a story of revival, restoring 63 water bodies and reviving the Ramrekha Canal, securing water for 70 villages. Refusing to accept scarcity, he mobilized local communities, IIT & IIM experts, and policymakers, turning conservation into a people's movement. His efforts have **revitalized agriculture**, ensuring farmers no longer struggle for irrigation. Aurangabad, once a cautionary tale of mismanagement, is now a model for large-scale water restoration. Sajjan's relentless work proves that when communities take ownership, water security is not just a dream but an achievable reality.



Vijendra Pratap Pandey, 62
Kangri, Haridwar, Uttarakhand

What makes him a water warrior: Vijendra Pratap Pandey has transformed Haridwar's spiritual devotion into environmental action, mobilizing communities for the Namami Gange initiative. As founder of Panth Nyas, he has spent four years leading workshops, awareness drives, and clean-up campaigns, making **water conservation a shared responsibility**. By aligning tradition with sustainability, he has ingrained Ganga protection into cultural practices, ensuring the river is not just worshiped but actively safeguarded. His leadership proves that conservation thrives when rooted in local values, turning devotion into action and community participation into lasting impact.

SK Shakila, 30
Nalgonda, Telangana



What makes her a water warrior: Shakila tackled water scarcity and poor sanitation by leading a desilting initiative to restore Pedda Cheruvu and Chinna Cheruvu irrigation tanks. Silt buildup had reduced the ayacut area from 950 to 380 acres, drying up rain-fed cotton fields. She mobilized villagers to rejuvenate 1,150 acres of farmland, constructing soak pits in 590 households, percolation pits in institutions, and community recharge pits. By using tank silt to revitalize soil and increase water retention, she restored **irrigation capacity** and improved crop yields. Her leadership turned a crisis into a sustainable solution, securing water and livelihoods for the village.



Shaik Rajiya, 39
Nalgonda, Telangana

What makes her a water warrior: For 18 years, Rajiya has championed sustainable water management under MGNREGS, shifting the village's focus to water conservation projects. She led the construction of percolation pits in schools, magic soak pits in households, and community soak pits to improve irrigation, soil moisture, and groundwater recharge. This shift **revitalized rain-fed agriculture boosted water availability**, and enhanced sanitation and public health. Her efforts transformed the village into a model of sustainability, proving that community-driven conservation can secure both livelihoods and environmental well-being. Rajiya's leadership turned water scarcity into a story of resilience and renewal.